

The Noble Perfection of Wisdom: A Text of One Hundred and Eight Names

Āryaprajñāpāramitānāmāṣṭaśatakam · Toh 25 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕྱི་རལ་དུ་ཞུ་བའི་མཆན་བརྒྱ་བརྒྱ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ

Toh 25 in the Kangyur is a short liturgical scripture known in English as "The Noble Perfection of Wisdom: A Text of One Hundred and Eight Names," corresponding to the Sanskrit Āryaprajñāpāramitānāmāṣṭaśatakam and the Tibetan Phags pa shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin pa'i mtshan brgya rtsa brgyad pa. It belongs to the Perfection of Wisdom class of texts and takes the form of a devotional hymn enumerating one hundred and eight names and epithets of the Perfection of Wisdom, personified as the mother of all buddhas across past, present, and future. Opening with a verse of homage to this "Blessed Lady," the text then proceeds to enumerate her names in rapid succession, covering qualities such as omniscience, suchness, emptiness, and signlessness. As part of the Kangyur, it sits within the vast Prajñāpāramitā scriptural tradition and reflects the deeply devotional as well as philosophical dimensions of that literature.

In the language of India: Āryaprajñāpāramitānāmāṣṭaśatakam. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Perfection of Wisdom: A Text of One Hundred and Eight Names.

Homage to the Blessed Lady, the Perfection of Wisdom.

Of all the Victors of past, future, and present,
you, O Virtuous One, are indeed the Mother.
You are the divine lady, daughter of the Victors,
endowed with the intrinsic nature of being without intrinsic nature.
I shall recite the names of her who has become
the Mother of the buddhas.
Those who wish for abundance, listen well.

The Perfection of Wisdom. Omniscience itself. Knowledge of all aspects of the path. Knowledge of all aspects. The perfect limit. Suchness. The infallible suchness. The non-other suchness. The true. The real. The genuine. The non-inverted. Emptiness. Signlessness. Wishlessness. Absence of phenomena. Essential nature. The essential nature of the absence of phenomena. The nature of reality. The dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena. The very fact of phenomena's abiding. The immutability of phenomena. The

faultlessness of phenomena. The defining mark of phenomena. The selflessness of phenomena. The absence of essential nature. The absence of sentient beings. The absence of a life-force. The absence of a nourishing principle. The absence of a person. The absence of an individual. The expressible. The inexpressible. That which is free from mind, mentation, and consciousness. The incomparable. The unequal. That which has no self-nature among equals and unequals. Freedom from pride. Absence of conceptual elaboration. Freedom from conceptual elaboration. Freedom from all conceptual elaboration. The thorough transcendence of all conceptual elaboration. Mother of all buddhas. She who gives birth to all bodhisattvas. She who holds all śrāvakas. She who creates all pratyekabuddhas. She who holds all worlds. She who has accumulated an inexhaustible collection of merit. She who causes wisdom to descend. She who performs miraculous feats. She who purifies the divine eye. She who completely purifies the divine ear. She who causes the minds of others to be known. She who causes the recollection of previous abodes. She who causes knowledge of death and birth. She who causes the exhaustion of all afflictions. The noble. The pure. The cleansed. She who abides in the foundations of mindfulness. She who is endowed with the power of right abandonment. She who is endowed with the four bases of miraculous power. She who purifies the faculties. She who produces strength. She who is without fault. She who is adorned with the seven precious limbs of awakening. She who bestows the seven noble riches. She who teaches the noble eightfold path. She who teaches the nine successive meditative absorptions. She who accomplishes the ten masteries. She who causes abiding on the ten grounds. She who causes the complete fulfillment of the ten powers. She who is adorned with the ten sense bases of exhaustion. She who accomplishes the ten knowledges. She who causes terror to the enemy of the ten underlying tendencies. She who causes the accomplishment of the meditative concentrations. She who causes complete transcendence of the formless realm. She who is praised by all perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. She who accomplishes all knowledge. She who causes the completion of all perfections. The emptiness of the inner. The emptiness of the outer. The emptiness of the outer and inner. The emptiness of emptiness. The great emptiness. The ultimate emptiness. The emptiness of the conditioned. The emptiness of the unconditioned. The emptiness beyond extremes.

The emptiness of having no beginning and no end. The emptiness of non-relinquishment. The emptiness of intrinsic nature. The emptiness of all phenomena. The emptiness of defining characteristics. The emptiness of the unapprehendable. The emptiness of non-existence. The emptiness of essential nature. The emptiness of the essential nature of non-existence.

Not arisen. Not born. Not ceased. Without annihilation. Without permanence. Not of a single meaning. Not of different meanings. Without coming. Without going. The cultivation of dependent origination. Not to be investigated analytically. Not to be cognized discursively. Without ground. Without characteristic. Not to be examined. Not to be known discursively. Making it so that there is no destruction at beginning or end. Making it so that there is no wavering. Neither two nor not-two. Peaceful. Free from the entry of conceptual thought. Without antidote. Unstained. Like the path of the sky. Not to be described as existent or non-existent. The essential nature of a dream. The nature of reality like an illusion. And like a spinning firebrand, all phenomena are of a single taste.

Whoever recites these one hundred and eight names of the Perfection of Wisdom shall be thoroughly liberated from all lower realms. All buddhas shall regard them with mindful attention. All bodhisattvas shall constantly and continuously protect, guard, and shelter them. These words of the mantra are also to be remembered without interruption, without ceasing.

Homage to the Blessed Lady, the noble Perfection of Wisdom, the beloved one devoted to the Perfection of Wisdom, she who is endowed with immeasurable qualities, she whose very omniscient knowing through the primordial wisdom of all Tathāgatas is honored by all buddhas and all bodhisattvas.

It is this:

Om prajñe prajñe mahāprajñe. Prajñā avabhāse. Prajñā ālokaḥ. Ajñānavidyamāne. Siddhi. Susiddhi. Sidhyamāne. Bhagavati sarvāṃgasundarī. Bhagavati. Vṛtasalī. Prasāritahaste. Samāśvāsakārī. Tiṣṭha tiṣṭha. Kampa kampa. Cala cala. Rāva rāva. Garjā garjā. Āgaccha āgaccha. Bhagavati māvilamba svāhā.

Whoever holds this Perfection of Wisdom shall be as one who has grasped the hundred-thousand-verse Perfection of Wisdom. If one recites it continuously, all karmic obscurations shall be completely purified. Even after passing away and taking rebirth from this life, one will have recollection of past lives, a stable mind, and incomparable wisdom. One shall grasp the entirety of the

Dharma of all Tathāgatas of the three times without exception. And all mantras and vidyā-mantras as well —

Translator's Notes

- The passage lists one hundred and eight names of the Perfection of Wisdom personified as a goddess. Several names in the middle section involve subtle philosophical distinctions: "the infallible suchness" and "the non-other suchness" render Tibetan terms that distinguish suchness as free from error and as not being something extraneous, respectively — standard Prajñāpāramitā epithets. The "ten sense bases of exhaustion" renders a technical Abhidharma category referring to the ten sense bases in their aspect of exhaustion or cessation; this is a less common formulation and worth noting for doctrinal specialists. The phrase rendered "she who holds all worlds" could also be read as "she who sustains all worlds," both senses being present in the Tibetan.
- The one-hundred-and-eight names referred to are those of the Perfection of Wisdom personified as a goddess, recited throughout this text. The phrase rendered "the beloved one devoted to the Perfection of Wisdom" translates a slightly compressed honorific construction; it could also be read as a vocative addressed to a devotee of the Perfection of Wisdom, but the context of a homage formula directed at the deity supports the reading given here. The mantra syllables are rendered in standard reconstructed Sanskrit transliteration following convention for such dhāraṇī passages; individual syllable meanings are not translated, as is standard practice. The final sentence ends mid-passage, indicating the text continues.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.